ruined a year of my life and done untold damage to my public standing. Given that the work I have been moving towards all my life has been founded on probity and ethical activism, this campaign against me has only proved useful to my enemies. At the time of writing, I am in the house of one of my bail sureties, under curfew in the English countryside with an electronic manacle on my leg. The use of such electronic monitoring in law enforcement dates back to 1983, when a judge in New Mexico called Jack Love read a cartoon in which a villain attaches an electronic tracking device to Spider-Man. Just like Old Bluey, my life is stranger than any fiction. I have not been charged with any crime, but, in an echo of the 'blood on his hands' manipulation, if you put the words 'Julian Assange rape' into a search engine it will return almost four million hits. The rape allegation was made, withdrawn and then made again, in the course of which I was already criminalised for the horrendous feat of having had consensual sex with two women in Stockholm in August 2010.

They aimed to draw blood, and did. I will not burrow down for you into any more detail: you have the picture. In autobiographical terms, it is strange to have to spend so much time on something so odd. All this happened, and has to be discussed, but it is just not me. It could have been a train crash, or a sudden conversion to Mormonism, or some other gratuitous unlikelihood that came to grab my attention in the middle of the best working year of my life; but it wasn't, it was a double rape allegation, and I have given it all the description I can.

Elsewhere, what passes for normal activity in my life was going on regardless. I remained in Sweden for more than a month after the allegations were first raised, but nothing was happening, and the Swedish prosecutor didn't seem to need to talk to me, so I caught a plane to England and went back to work. A European Arrest Warrant would soon follow hard on my heels, but for now it was time to prepare, along with our jumpy media partners, for Cablegate, the biggest unauthorised disclosure in history.